

PROGRAMMING IN JAVA-EVALUATED PROJECT

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EXPENSE TRACKER

1. Introduction

The **Expense Tracker** is a simple Python-based command-line application designed to help users keep track of their daily expenses. Instead of maintaining expenses manually, the application allows users to enter and store their spending details in an organized CSV file. It provides a simple way to view and understand where money is spent.

2. Objective

The main purpose of this project is to create an easy-to-use system for recording and managing personal expenses. The application allows users to maintain expense records, calculate their total spending, organize expenses based on categories, and search for particular expenses whenever required.

3. Technologies Used

The project is developed using **Python** and is designed to run completely through the command line or terminal. A **CSV file** is used to store expense records. The program uses Python's built-in csv, os, and datetime modules, so no additional external libraries are required.

4. Features

The application provides several useful options for managing expenses. Users can add a new expense by entering the date, category, description, and amount. They can view all their recorded expenses, calculate their total spending, and see a category-wise summary to understand their spending patterns. The application also provides a search option that allows users to find expenses using a category or description.

5. Working of the Project

When the program is started, it displays a menu with different options. The user can select the required operation by entering the corresponding number. When a new expense is added, the details are stored in the **expenses.csv** file. The program reads the stored data whenever the user wants to view, search, or calculate expenses. If the CSV file does not already exist, the program automatically creates it with the required headings.

6. Project Structure

The project contains four main files. The **expense_tracker.py** file contains the complete Python program and handles all the operations. The **expenses.csv** file is used to store expense records. The **requirements.txt** file is included for dependency information, although this project uses only Python's built-in modules. The **README.md** file provides the project description and instructions for setting up and running the application.

7. Execution

The project is designed to be easily executed from a terminal without requiring any graphical interface. After opening the project directory in a terminal, the application can be started using the command **python expense_tracker.py**. Once started, the user can choose different options from the displayed menu and manage their expenses.

8. Conclusion

The Expense Tracker is a simple and practical project that demonstrates how Python can be used to solve a common day-to-day problem. Through this project, basic concepts such as functions, user input, file handling, CSV data storage, and data processing are applied in a useful way. The application provides a straightforward method for maintaining and analyzing expense records from the command line.